

Diet Weed Or Deception?

*Evaluating the marketing and health information
of "federally legal" cannabis products*

Chess Blacklock, Meredith McGee, Yale School of Public Health



Background

The **2018 Farm Bill** legalized hemp (<0.3% THC by weight) in the U.S., allowing interstate sales even where cannabis is illegal. Hemp products are largely exempt from packaging and advertising restrictions that currently apply to state-legal cannabis

Future Directions

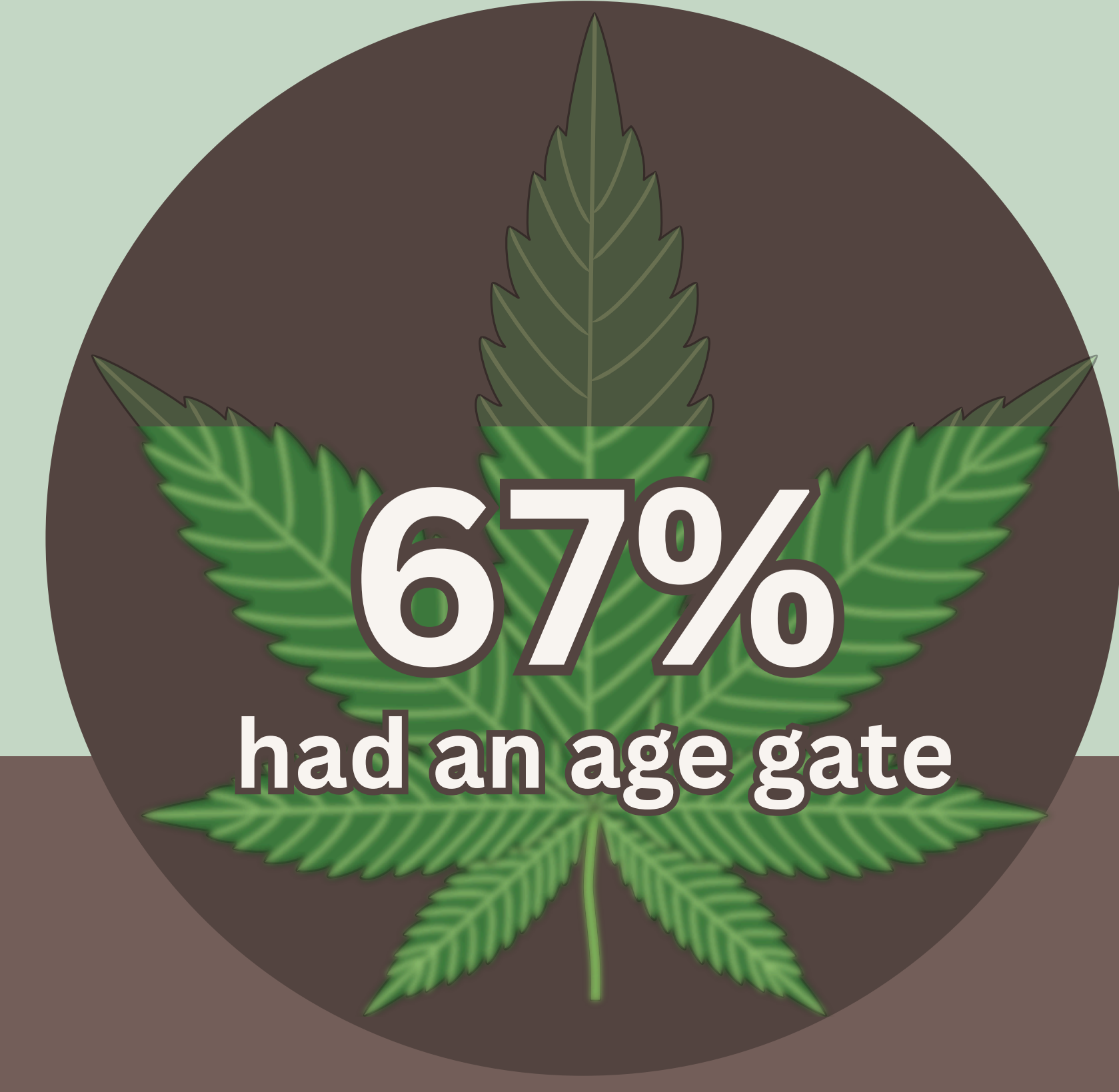
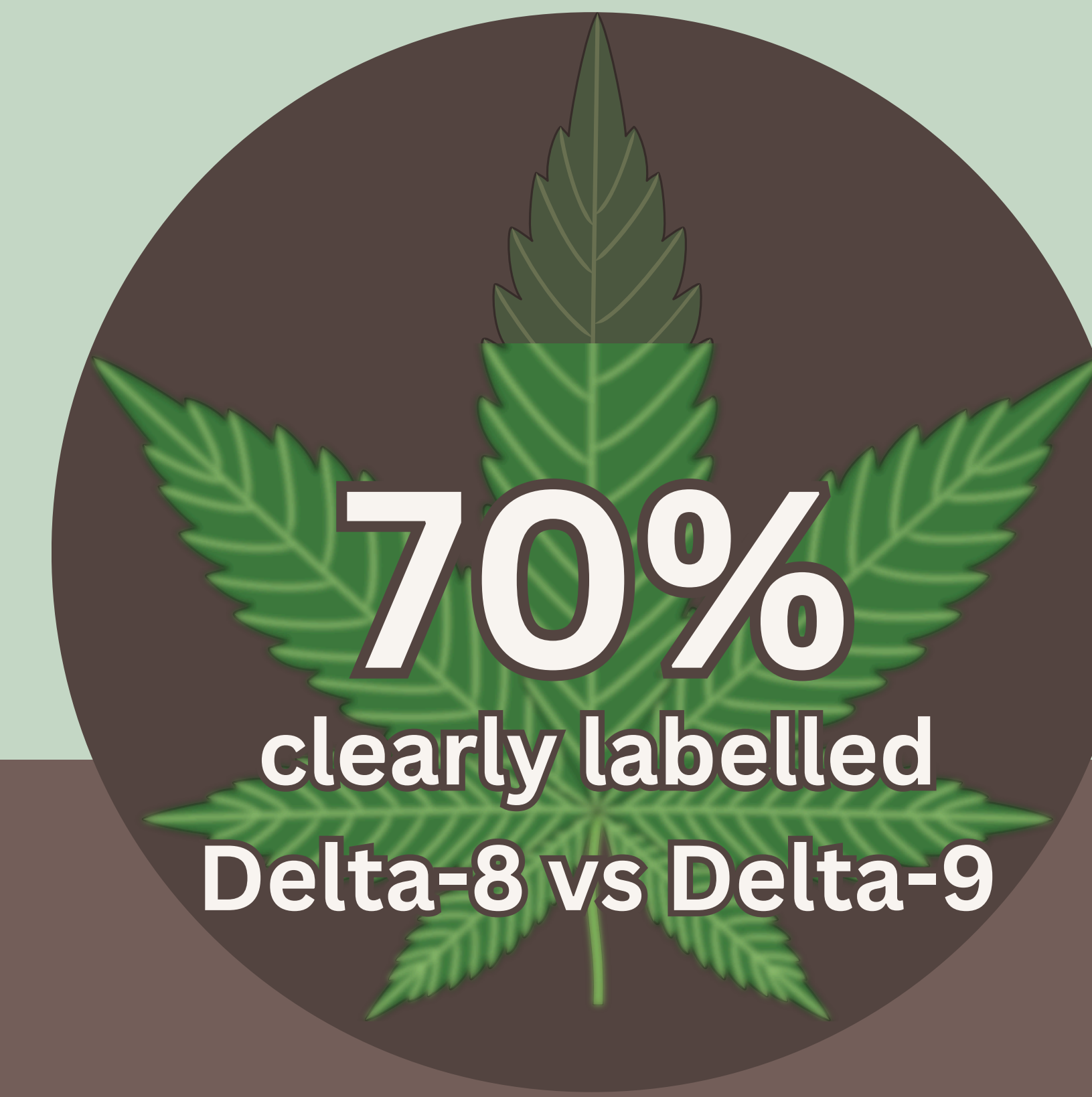
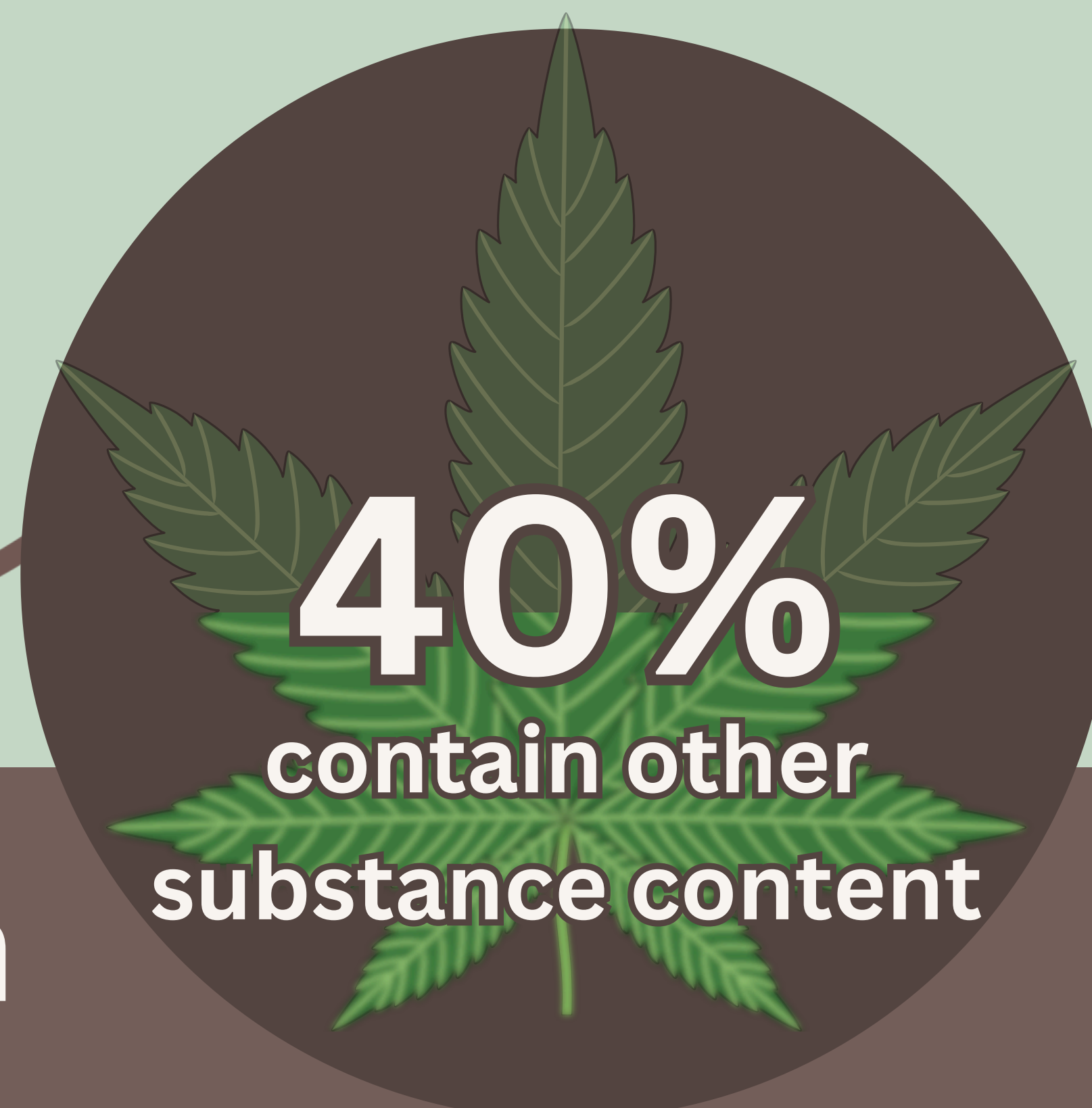
Comparing marketing as marijuana alternatives vs health products, evaluate implications for low quality scores

Purpose To evaluate the marketing practices and health information provided by companies selling hemp-derived THC products

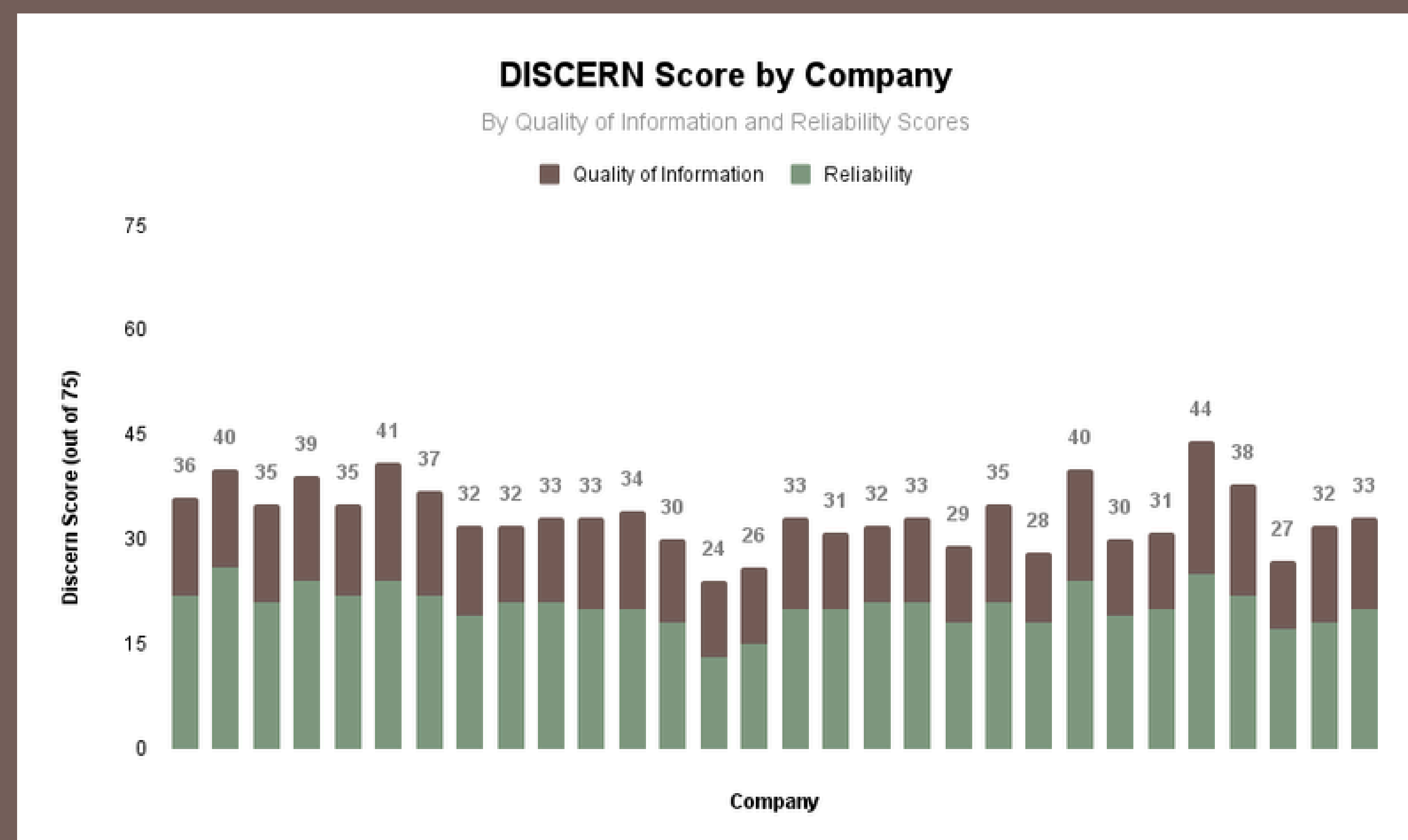
Methods Google search to identify U.S.-based companies selling hemp-derived THC products. Data collected on product types, THC concentrations, shipping availability, legal claims, and lab testing were collected from 30 companies. The DISCERN tool was used to assess the quality of available health information.

Most common substances included:

1. L-theanine (5/30)
2. Melatonin (4/30)
3. Caffeine (3/30)
4. B Vitamins (3/30)



Results & Discussion



The average Quality of Information scores were consistently lower than the average Reliability scores, indicating a need for improvement in external sources and additional information.

The questions with the lowest average scores were those related to the presentation of alternative products and the sharing of sources used.